Camera Deck for ChasePlane

Setup guide: your ChasePlane cameras on the Stream Deck, organised the way you organise them in ChasePlane.



The home screen: your ChasePlane groups on the keys, and the camera dials and touch strip below.

ACMS Digital Systems · Camera Deck for ChasePlane 0.1.0.22 · Microsoft Flight Simulator 2024

1. What it does

The deck is a page on your Stream Deck that fills itself from ChasePlane while you fly. You do not set up keys one by one. You organise your cameras in ChasePlane, and the deck follows:

- **Home screen:** your ChasePlane groups, one row each for Onboard, Outside and World.
- **Press a group:** the same keys show that group's camera views. Press a view to switch the camera.
- **Live:** rename, reorder, add or delete a view or group in ChasePlane and the deck changes within a second. Load another aircraft and the deck shows its views.
- **Lit:** the group and the view the camera is on are highlighted (white name and a ring).

Nothing in ChasePlane is changed by the deck. It only reads your views and groups and asks ChasePlane to switch cameras.

2. What you need

Item	Notes
Microsoft Flight Simulator 2024	Running, with an aircraft loaded.
ChasePlane by Parallel 42	Running. The deck talks to ChasePlane on this PC; nothing to set up.
Stream Deck + XL	9 x 4 keys and 6 dials. The layout in this guide is for the + XL.
Stream Deck app 7.1 or newer	Windows 10 or 11.
Camera Deck for ChasePlane plugin	The file **com.acms.chaseplane.streamDeckPlugin**.

3. Install the plugin

- Keep the Stream Deck app open and double-click **com.acms.chaseplane.streamDeckPlugin**. Click Install if asked.
- Stream Deck offers the ready-made **Camera Deck for ChasePlane** profile for your + XL. Accept it: the whole deck is set up for you (section 4 shows what is on it).
- In the Stream Deck app, the action list on the right now has a **Camera Deck for ChasePlane** category.
- Updating later: double-click the new file the same way. Stream Deck only accepts a file with a newer version number.

4. The deck page

The **Camera Deck for ChasePlane** profile comes laid out like this. To build it on another page yourself, drag the same actions from the **Camera Deck for ChasePlane** list:

Where	What to drag	What it becomes
Rows 1 to 3, every key	**Deck Key**	The live keys: group names on the home screen, camera views inside a group.
Row 4, right	**Flashlight**, **Cinematic**, **My Aircraft**, **Status**	Fixed controls on every screen. Status shows green CONNECTED and your aircraft, or red OFFLINE. The rest of row 4 is Deck Keys; swap any for keys of your own.
All 6 dials	**Deck Dial**	Each dial takes its job from its position (section 8).

Tip: a Deck Key works out its job from where it sits, so every Deck Key is the same. Drag one, then copy and paste it to fill the rows. Keep the top-left key a Deck Key: inside a group it becomes the **Home** key.

5. Set up your groups in ChasePlane

Groups are ChasePlane's camera profiles (Pilot, Instruments, Cabin and so on). On the deck each group is one key on the home screen.

Rule	Why
Keep group names to **10 letters or fewer**, in capitals: PILOT, PANELS, GOPRO, SEATING.	The group name is printed in the coloured band on every one of its view keys. Longer names shrink, and past about 17 letters they are cut short.
Put the groups in the order you want them.	The home screen shows them in ChasePlane's order, Onboard first, then Outside, then World.
Pick each group's category (theme) with care.	The category sets the colour: cockpit cyan, cabin purple, chase red, and so on. Groups in the same category share a colour.
Empty groups are fine.	A group with no views on the loaded aircraft is hidden, and appears when it has one.
To break a long group name over two lines, type **|** where the break goes: CABIN|VIEWS.	Group names keep the | character. (View names do not; see section 6.)

6. Name your camera views

The view name is what the key shows, so the name is the layout. Use this format:

SUBJECT / DETAIL in capitals. A slash with a space on each side starts a second line. **GOPRO / CAPT 1** shows as GOPRO over CAPT 1.

Rule	Example
At most two lines of about 9 letters each (13 at most).	OVERHEAD / UPPER
Short names need no break. Up to 11 letters fit on one line.	MCP, EFB, PILOT, JUMPSEAT
A slash **without** spaces stays on one line.	GOPRO / F/O, WATER/TOILET / GSX
Leave out left and right. ChasePlane adds L, R, FWD, MID and AFT from where the camera sits, and the key shows them on its bottom line.	THROTTLE (not THROTTLE LEFT)
Use the same words every time.	CAPT, F/O, FWD, AFT, ENG, GSX, CLOSE
Give copies a real difference instead of -1 or Copy of.	ENGINE / 2 ALT

Do not use | in view names. It works while you type it, but ChasePlane removes it the next time the sim starts, and the name then runs together (GOPRO|CAPT 1 becomes GOPROCAPT 1). Use the slash with spaces instead.

7. Passenger seats

A group of seats is laid out like a cabin seen from above: one deck row per seat letter (A above F), seats front to back from left to right. This happens by itself when a group has at least four views whose names end in a row number and a letter:

Works	Does not work
1A, 14F, SEAT 7A, SEAT / 23F	WINDOW 14 LEFT, SEAT A14, 14 F WINDOW

- Up to **8 seat rows** and **3 seat letters** fit. A bigger cabin falls back to ChasePlane's order.
- Other views in the same group (galleys, FA panels) fill the free keys after the seats.
- Name the group anything you like, for example SEATING.



A seating group: A seats on one row, F seats below, front to back. The dials and touch strip follow the open group.

8. The dials

Each dial has a section of the touch strip above it showing what it controls. Push the dial or tap its section of the strip to use the push action.

Dial	Turn	Push or tap
1 GROUP	Step through your groups; the keys follow	Back to the home screen
2 VIEW	Previous or next view in the open group (or the group the camera is in)	First view of the group
3 MODE	Cockpit, Exterior, World	Next mode
4 CINEMATIC	Next cinematic shot	Cinematics on or off
5 SMART CAM	Not yet available	Not yet available
6 TRAFFIC	Step through nearby aircraft	Back to your aircraft

Turning quickly shows your choice straight away and switches the camera once the dial stops.

9. When something is not right

What you see	What to do
Status is red OFFLINE, home screen empty	Start the sim and ChasePlane. The deck connects by itself within a few seconds.
Keys say "unable to identify plugin"	The plugin is not installed. Double-click the plugin file (section 3).
A group is missing from the home screen	It has no views on this aircraft. Add a view to it in ChasePlane.
A view name runs together (GOPROCAPT 1)	It was written with |. Rename it with a slash and spaces: GOPRO / CAPT 1.
A group name is cut short on the keys	Shorten it to 10 letters or fewer in ChasePlane.
Seats are not in cabin order	Check the names end in number and letter (14F), and that the cabin has 8 rows or fewer.
A key shows a yellow warning triangle	ChasePlane could not switch to that view. Check it still exists in ChasePlane.